

Scams • Chapter 5

Fake tools

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A fake tool is an extension or app that does more than its page says, or makes stopping hard. In my experience few are malware, and most are working code with a hidden price.

Verified | Reported | Vivian's field notes

In 30 seconds

- A tool can send, reach or change more than its page says, and it stays on your computer until you remove it.
- Most harm comes from design: no cap, no running total, no stop that always works.
- A tool that is harmless today and could turn harmful after one update needs a different verdict from "malware".
- Remote control, background buying and tools that act as you are the highest risks.
- A feature built to make the next payment harder to refuse is a reason to leave.

You will learn

- What a tool can do that its page does not say.
- How to word a verdict so that it says what was read.
- The pressure features to recognise, and the minimum a safe tool shows.
- Why remote access and borrowed sign-ins are a red line.
- Why protection inside an app is weak, and what that means for you.

A tool is a promise written in code. Some promises are broken, and some are kept and still cost you more than you meant to pay. I will show you the shapes they take, so that you can say no before the install and not after the bill. To check one, use Check a tool before you install it.

— **Vivian**

What a tool can do that its page does not say

In this wiki a fake tool is any extension or app that sends more than it says, acts beyond what you agreed, or makes stopping hard. In my experience few of them are malware, and most are working code with a hidden price or no way out.

A tool outruns its page in four ways.

- *It sends more.* A tool can build a machine identifier from the names of your computer and your account, send it to its server and show it on screen. That exposes who you are.

- *It reaches further.* A tool that keeps your signed-in session and buys in the background removes the pause between decisions. The only brake left is a cap you set beforehand.
- *It changes later.* An updater can fetch new files after you have stopped paying attention.
- *It skips consent.* A roleplay app can look grand and still have no safe word, no consent screen and no aftercare, and some of its promised content may never arrive. A dom who uses consent tools shows them: a stop control, a log of what she can see, and a clear line between teasing and harming.

Vivian's field notes

A tool that stays installed is a standing risk. If you ignore it today and its maker pushes a harmful update tomorrow, you are exposed, and a maker could wait until many people have installed it. Removing the tool is the simplest exit, and a person who has removed it cannot be drained by it.

Not malicious today

Calling a tool malware before reading all of it can produce a false alarm that has to be taken back. The sequence below is an invented example, because a correction is more useful than an alarm.

A verdict that matches what was read (invented example)

1. ### First reading

   A quick look at a control app suggests the worst: stored sign-in tokens and a link to a remote server.

2. ### Full reading

   Reading the whole source, updater and every network call included, shows what is really sent and to whom.

3. ### The finding

   If the updater can push any file and the tokens sit on the same computer, one update could take everything.

4. ### The wording

   The honest verdict names what was read and what could change: harmless today, risky after one update.

A finding like that is narrower than “malware” and still serious. A design risk is the usual kind of danger, and it needs a verdict worded to match. Check a tool before you install it gives the ladder of words.

Myth

If a tool is not malware, it is fine.

Fact

A tool can be free of malware and still send identifying details about your computer to its server. A tool can be harmless in code and unsafe in use.

Myth

A tool has a stop if you can close the program.

Fact

Some tools can only be stopped by force-closing the app or turning the computer off. A stop that depends on your willpower is no stop. Force-closing always works, so know it, but a visible stop that works in every state must also exist.

Designs that push you to spend

A cap set in advance is your first brake. The features below work against it, and each makes the next payment harder to refuse. Press reports guilt-based pressure from some dominants, and a former participant describes men who sold cars, took on debt and worked second jobs. Reported A tool that automates the same guilt is the same tactic.

Red flags

Designs to refuse

- A forced respin, or a prompt that cannot be closed without choosing.
- Minimum amounts that rise after each round.
- A sentence you must type to continue.
- A mascot that sulks, scolds or pleads until you act.
- A hidden total, or a charged amount that differs from the one shown.
- A lock that releases only on payment, or a tool that cannot be removed.
- Overnight modes, or targeting of payday and of your balance.

Counter. Close it and leave. These features exist to earn from your next send. Assume a tool has none of the protections below until you see them.

The minimum a safe tool shows

	What a safe tool does	If it is missing
Start	Arrives switched off, with one master switch	Do not install
Scope	Does one named thing on one named site	Ask for the limit, or leave
Total	Shows a running total and counts only confirmed payments	Do not install
Cap	Enforces the cap you set in advance	Set a limit at your bank
Wait	Spaces payments with a cooldown	Ask for it
Stop	One visible stop that works in every state	Do not install
Removal	Can be removed in one click	Do not install

Safe design often means earning less, and a tool that has all of this has given something up. Even then, a determined person can defeat a blocking or draining

extension, so a tool should never be your only control. See Breaks that hold.

Remote control and tools that act as you

A remote-session hands your computer to someone else, and a US government alert advises people not to give control of their computers or mobile devices to any stranger. Verified The full red line, with the pressure lines to refuse, is in Check a tool before you install it.

A hub-style app can add remote actions: making accounts follow, post or send, sending files, or reaching a terminal. If it does, one flaw lets the author, or anyone, act through every installed copy. An app like that deserves an independent security check before release, and a person who finds such a flaw should tell the maker and not use it.

Red flags

Tools that act as you

- It likes, follows or posts from your accounts.
- It keeps your signed-in session and buys in the background.
- It is advertised as getting around your bank's confirmation step.
- It asks you to hand over a password, a login code or a connection code.

Counter. Refuse. Automation on your account can get it banned and can flag the dom's account for botting, and the consequence lands on you. A version built to defeat your own bank's check removes a brake that protects your money.

Sign-ins and second steps

What is a session token?

Answer

A stored credential that keeps a program signed in to your account without asking for your password. 

What can its holder do?

Answer

Act as you, without the password and without the second step. 

Does a second step protect a session that has been taken?

Answer

No. The second step is asked at sign-in, and a taken session has already signed in. 

After a doubtful tool, what do you do?

Answer

Sign out everywhere, then change your passwords from a different computer. 

Protection that is not protection

Vivian's field notes

Makers encrypt images and scramble code to keep copies away. The key and the logic still ship inside the app, so a person with patience, ordinary tools or an assistant can read all of it. Whatever your computer can open, someone can extract. Scrambling deters casual copying and does nothing against a determined reader. The same openness is your advantage: a tool you can inspect is a tool you can check, so I prefer them.

A build step can change what a tool does, so the build that ships may differ from the one that was tested. A wrong version can charge an amount different from the one it shows. A test switch that skips the payment step, a bypass, must never leave the maker's computer. Makers: the list is in Check a tool before you install it.

A tool can also trap the people it is meant to serve. A bug, an overlay or a lock can leave a sub with no way to remove a tool. A lock that opens only on payment is a paid exit and a reason to leave, because it turns a game you agreed to into a harm you did not. A maker needs an automatic unlock and no overlay that covers the stop.

If you have installed a tool you now doubt, the steps are in Check a tool before you install it. If money has left, go to If you already sent.

Which of these tools passes?

Five tools are offered to you. On this list alone, only one is acceptable. Which one?

A A control app that can be stopped only by turning the computer off

Not this one. A stop that depends on your willpower is no stop.

B A background buyer that keeps your session and shows no running total

Not this one. The only brake left is a cap that you cannot watch working.

C An app whose mascot sulks until you spin again

Not this one. A guilt line built into a tool is pressure by design.

D An app that needs a remote session to finish setting up

Not this one. Full control of your computer cannot be taken back.

E A tool that arrives off, does one named thing on one named site, shows a running total and has a stop that works in every state

The right answer. It passes this list. It still needs the full check, and your own cap.

Remember it

1. In my experience few fake tools are malware, and most are working code with a hidden price or no way out.
2. A verdict says what was read: “not malicious today” is not “safe”.
3. A feature built to make the next send harder to refuse is a reason to leave.
4. A safe tool arrives off, shows a total, enforces your cap and stops in every state.
5. Nobody who plays fair needs remote control of your computer or your sign-in.
6. Whatever your computer can open, someone can read. Prefer tools you can inspect.

Check it

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

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   Vivian’s field notes

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3 That exposes who you are.

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5 An updater can fetch new files after you have stopped paying attention.

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6 A dom who uses consent tools shows them: a stop control, a log of what she can see, and a clear line between teasing and harming.

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14 A tool can be harmless in code and unsafe in use.

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15 Force-closing always works, so know it, but a visible stop that works in every state must also exist.

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16 Press reports guilt-based pressure from some dominants, and a former participant describes men who sold cars, took on debt and worked second jobs.

Reported

[a former participant] has seen men left broke and hungry from 'paying women to talk to them' (https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20251123124217/https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Accessed 3 November 2026

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18 Even then, a determined person can defeat a blocking or draining extension, so a tool should never be your only control.

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19 A remote-session hands your computer to someone else, and a US government alert advises people not to give control of their computers or mobile devices to any stranger.

Verified

IC3 Issues Alert on Tech Support Fraud (https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2018/03/29/ic3-issues-alert-tech-support-fraud)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20250716102123/https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2018/03/29/ic3-issues-alert-tech-support-fraud)

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20 If it does, one flaw lets the author, or anyone, act through every installed copy.

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Vivian's field notes

Free, confidential helplines exist in most countries.

→

Find a helpline

Findom Wiki by Vivian 18+

Nothing here is financial, legal or medical advice for your situation.